Rukiza by Justinian Mugasha

Translated and Edited by P. S.

Justinian Mugasha's performance of *Rukiza* is a series of poetic vignettes that depicts how one-time cattle-holding haves became have-nots. A familiar thematic opposition motivates that sequence and emerges with stark contrast in an armed conflict between the forces of a king and those of a clan patriarch. This ultimately tragic struggle (as it is portrayed) develops equally within military, supernatural, and domestic dimensions. It is set in motion and framed with the two protagonists' quickly aroused loyalties, their contrasting sentiments regarding cattle, and an elaborate poetics of subordination.

The scenes that precede the pair's first battle are key thematic moments. King Ruhinda reacts in hot anger at the report that the patriarch Rukiza has treated his own cattle in a manner that implies disrespect and devaluation (but the audience knows the accusation is false). In the next scene, the clan leader is quick to honor the most tenuous of kin relationships, the fictive kinship of blood brotherhood, to grant audience and aid to a poorly dressed fellow who appears one morning in his cattle kraal (even though the poor man's claim of blood brotherhood with the patriarch is never substantiated).

The king's instant concern with a perceived insult to cattle contrasts with the patriarch's concern for his herd's well being, which earlier caused him to bid farewell to his mother and migrate from his ancestral home. The same kin-like, caring sentiment informed his decision to receive his poor, putative, blood brother.

The singer's proverb at the end of the ballad completes a string of figures, composed mostly in the form of personal names, that speak of subordination. His final comment, made after the patriarch has been killed, his cattle confiscated, and his clan left to wander, "Shoju grass pricks the foot when short. When it grows, it thatches a house," proverbially asserts the power of the downtrodden to eventually rise. The symbols also mirror the natural species and the house type (musonge) that play supernatural roles in the tale.

The social fault lines in this epic world are compounded by the rupture that can occur between brothers and sisters when the sister marries and goes to live with the members of her husband's clan. There she may build solidarity with that clan to the detriment of her brother's clan. These two oppositions - king-clan and man-woman - are the principal thematic compass points that situate the action in this and in many of the ballads. Justinian Mugasha sang this version of Rukiza to an audience of three persons (two of them native Haya speakers) in the afternoon of January 13, 1969, by my request in the small wattle-and-daub house of Haruna Batonde in Katome village, Kihanja, in Kagera Region of Tanzania.

I begin to play the epic of Rukiza.
Mugasha Ibibi.
I am Mugasha,
Justinian Mugasha.

Listen to Ibibi.
Listen to Mugasha.
Listen, let me tell you.
Be listening, let me tell you.
Be listening, let me tell you.
Let me tell you of Rukiza Mbibi,
5 *Splitter of mukoni wood; it dries.*

Rukiza's father orphaned him still in the womb.
His mother carried him within.
He developed, Rukiza.
He was born, the Muganga.
He nursed and he was weaned, the Muganga.
He played with the children.

My friend, my friend, my friend, my friend,
As he played with the children, Mbibi,
10 As he grew, he began to think,
"I'd like to go and see
The cattle that my father left me and
The place that they were pastured."

Coming to the fallow fields he found
The fields pressed in
And the cattle overstepped their bounds.

He turned homeward; he returned.

Nabanza kuteela enanga ya Rukiza.
Mugasha Ibibi.
Ndi Mugasha,
Yustinian Mugasha.

Hulila Ibibi.
Hulila Mugasha.
Hulila, mbagambile.
Muhulile mbagambile.
Muhulile mbagambile.
Mbagambile Rukiza Mbibi,
5 *Lugangabul' emikoni ekooma*

Rukiza ishe akamusiga ali nda.
Nyina yatwaala enda.
Yakula Rukiza.
Yazaalwa Omuganga.
Yayonka yachuuka Omuganga.
Yazaana n' abaana.

Baaba, baaba, baaba, baaba,
Kayazaana n' abaana, Mbibi,
10 Kayakula yayemwamu,
Ahi, 'Kangye kuleba
(Mbali taata) ente za taata ezoyansigiile
Mbali zilikuliila.'

Kugya omu lweeya yashanga
Olweeya lwafunda
N' ente zashaaga.

Yalugayo yagya.

Plot Outline

Lines 1-5:
The singer identifies himself and the ballad's hero.

Lines 6-8:
Rukiza's father died before the hero's birth; he grew up within the Baganga clan.

Lines 9-12.2:
As he grows to manhood, he becomes concerned with the state of the cattle his father has bequeathed him; he finds that their pasture is not adequate.

Notes

4.1 *Mbibi* is the name of the hero's mother or his father's mother according to singers and many critics. The name often accompanies or substitutes for Rukiza's name. According to Cory and Hartnoll 1945, it is the name of the (male) founder of the Baganga clan.

5 *Mukoni* wood is used in walking sticks (*enkoni*) and implies strength and violence.

7.2 *Muganga* (pl. *Baganga*) is Rukiza's clan.

Poetic Stanzas

1-5: The introductory passage consists of three linegroups marked by repetition throughout; in the first linegroup (1-2) substitution of names associated with the epic proceeds from the hero's (1) to a composite of the hero's and the bard's (1.1) to the bard's Haya name (1.2) and finally to the bard's full, Christian plus Haya name (2); the second linegroup (3-3.3) is a *stanza* in **aab**b formed by a repeated initial verb that introduces proper nouns (**a**'s: 3, 3.1) and then, to finalize the figure, introduces a verb instead (**b**: 3.2); the figure is then *refinalized* by changing the inflection of the same initial verb from imperative to subjunctive (3.3); the third linegroup (4-5) is a *stanza* in **aab** formed by lines that cohere by chaining of the subjunctive aside "let me tell you" (**a**'s: 4-4.1) contrasted with a single line composed of praise (5).

6-8.1: Passage whose semantic structure depends on an expected cultural sequence - father, mother, conception, gestation, birth, nursing, weaning and childhood; the first line pair treats, respectively, father and mother (6-7); the following linegroup (7.1-8.1) is formed as **aab**b by lines composed according to the formula / verb initial + subject final/ contrasted with a single line whose similar syntax is augmented by a double verb formula (8); the following line (8.1) *refinalizes* the passage by varying the verb initial formula with a concluding prepositional phrase; like the refinalization directly above (3.3) this line creates an incremental repetition that drives the narrative forward.

9.1-11.1: *stanza* in **aa**x**bb** formed by lines that begin with marked adverbial uses of the near past (**a**'s: 9.1, 10) contrasted with lines that end with past perfect verbs (**b**'s: 11, 11.1); the couplets are separated by an interpolated line (10.1).

He spoke to his mother.
He said, "Mother I must emigrate.
He said, "I found my cattle lack a proper pasture."
His mother said, "You should not go before you've married,
Long-lived-one."
15 They were done; they made a marriage pact.
He married, the Muganga.

When he had completed the marriage ceremonies,
And when the wife had emerged from seclusion,
the *Long-lived-one*,
He said, "Mother, I spoke of emigrating."
He said, "Let us emigrate and go."
His mother refused.

He left her eight hundred cattle.
Bulls, he left her one whole hundred.
20 He left her herders too.
He emigrated, the Muganga of Ilundu.

He came with Baganga,
And the Baganga were many,
The Baganga of Ilundu.

Yagambila nyina.
Ahi, 'Maawe nafuluka.'
Ahi, 'Nashanga ente zange zabulwa obuliilo.'
Nyina ahi, 'Tiwakugenda otashweile *Nyakutununta*.'

15 Bakaba basheleile.
Yashweela Omuganga.

Kayamazile kushweela
K'omukazi yayalukile *Nyakutununta*

Ahi, 'Maawe ngambile kufuluka.'
Ahi, 'Tufuluke tugende.'
Nyina yayanga.

Akamusigila ente amaganai munana.
Enumi yamusigila eigana lyoona.
20 Yamusigila na ab' okuliisa.
Yafuluka Omuganga wa Ilundu.

Akaija na Abaganga
Mala Abaganga bangi,
Abaganga ba Ilundu.

Plot Outline

Lines 13-21:
Rukiza urges his mother to migrate with him to seek better pastures, but his mother refuses, requiring that he first take a wifezz, but then refusing to go anyway. He leaves her cattle and herders to care for them and emigrates.

Lines 22-34.1:
The names of the clan members who accompany him are noted, and they foreshadow themes in the action to come.

Notes

The hero's identity takes shape within a matrix of kinship. We learn of his father, his mother, the other children of his lineage, and in another version, his grandfather as well. Kin attachments also introduce Mugasha, who, like Rukiza in another version, miraculously speaks to his mother from inside her womb. This initial emphasis on kin contrasts with the opening of *Kachwenyanja*(ll. 1–6), in which the hero is described territorially, using placenames and descriptions. Divergent ways of qualifying heros place them in disparate ethical spheres and create different expectations and rationales of action.

14 *Long-lifed-one*: *Nyakutununta*, related to *entununsi*, a beating heart (see below l. 151), epithet for a living person who sustains and is sustained by family.

Cattle appear within a matrix of kin: the hero inherits herds from his father —contrary to actual practice in the traditional Haya state. His concern for their needs in land and food echoes kinship principles, which regulated the distribution of these linked resources through the institution of the patrilineal clan. The king's ethics of cattle are portrayed quite differently (l. 86) and are consonant with the structures of the state.

The symbolic combination of kin and cattle continues in Rukiza's generous bequest to his mother and his continued care for the herds still in his charge.

Poetic Stanzas

13-15.1: *verse* in **aba**, 2 + 3 + 2; initial and final linegroups (**a**'s: 13-13.1, 15-15.1) are double verb formations followed by initial verbs; the middle linegroup (**b**: 13.2-14) is internally structured as a *stanza* in **aab** formed by two lines that have initial locutives and are comprised of quoted utterances by Lukiza (13.2, 13.3) contrasted with a single line that has a non-initial locutive and is comprised of a quoted utterance by Lukiza'a mother (14).
16-17.2: *compound stanza* in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 1; initial line pairs cohere by initial adverbial particles and initial locutives, respectively (**a**'s: 16-16.1, 17-17.1); the stanza is finalized by Lukiza's mother's single line response (**b**: 17.2).
18-21: *stanza* in **aa**a**b** formed by repetition of verb "leave" in applied form (**a**'s: 18-20) contrasted with its absence (**b**: 21); note elaborated word order: **a**'s: verb + direct object, direct object + verb, verb + direct object; **b**: verb + subject
22-23: Three lines of incremental repetition.

Plot Outline

Lines 22-34.1 (cont.):
The names of the clan members who accompany him are noted, and they foreshadow themes in the action to come.

Lines 35-41:
Rukiza searches for a place to settle with adequate and safe pastures, but does not find any at first.

Notes

24ff: Clansmen's names evoke aspects of home and family. *Honey-bee*(l. 24) insect society represents domestic unity, as in a folktale in which bees rescue a woman who has been driven from her home by wild animals (Seitel 1980: 219-224). *Elephant-grass*(l. 26), a type of bamboo, and *yojwe* grass (28.1) are used in house construction, the former in framing, the latter as periodically changed carpeting. The magical connection between person, house, and family later becomes central to the plot (149ff.). Private family matters are revealed in *Impotence* (l. 30.2), with his cohorts, *Does-not-penetrate* (l. 30.1) and *Water-of-yam-leaves*(l. 30), which is food eaten to stave off starvation. Proclaiming them as personal names seems a strategic form of self-presentation known as "making oneself small." Such a public stance implies that the speaker represents an unexpected but powerful threat to anyone who would contend with him. This is the posture of subjugated clans in a royal state, and it is also reflected in the figurative comment at the end of the epic, "*Shoju*grass sticks the foot when short./ When it grows, it thatches a house..."(ll. 202-202.1). *Water* (32) can likewise be a symbol of weakness, but is also powerful (as in *Mugasha*), and like clans, is associated with agriculture and reproduction, and is ubiquitous, a theme also articulated in concluding commentary (l. 194-195).

With Honey-bee, a Muganga,
25 He departed Ilundu of Lukaile.
With Elephant-grass *Nyakilika*, himself a Muganga,

He departed Ilundu of Lukaile.
My friend, my friend,
    With Yojwe grass *Ilolwa* and Stinging-flies of
        Buhunga,
    Herself a Muganga woman of Ilundu.

He came with many Baganga.
30 With Water-of-yam-leaves,
    With Does-not-penetrate,
    With Impotence,
Themselves Baganga.
    They departed Ilundu of Lukaile.
My friend, and with Water,
Herself a Muganga woman of Ilundu,
With Squash plant, a Muganga woman,
    He departed Ilundu of Lukaile.

35 My friend, my friend,
    He came to Karagwe.
    He found wilderness spread before him;
He finds lions roar.
He says, "I'll not build here
    Lest lions eat my cattle."
Pressing on, he migrated.

    In Ruhija in Kihanja
    He finds. . .

N' Enjoki Muganga,
25 Akaluga Ilundu lya Lukaile.
Olubingo *Nyakilika* na wenene Muganga,

Akaluga Ilundu lya Lukaile.
Baaba, baaba,
    Yoojwe *Iloolwa* n' Entambila za Buhunga,

    Nawe Mugangakazi wa Ilundu.

Akaija na Abaganga bangi.
30 N' Amaizi g' olubota,
    Na Kitachuga,
    Na Mbolo efile,
Na bonene Baganga.
    Bakaluga Ilundu lya Lukaile.
Baaba, n' Amaizi,
Na gonene Gagangakazi ga Ilundu,
Olutontozi Mugangakazi,
    Akaluga Ilundu lya Lukaile.

35 Baaba, baaba,
    Yaija Kalagwe.
    Yashanga amalungu gateeka;
Ashanga entale zasinda.
Ahi, 'Tindakwombekamu,
    Entale zitandiila ente zange.'
Naguma afulukile.

    Luhija Kihanja.
    Ashanga . . .

Squash plant(l. 34) evokes associations of fertility and bodily desire (as in the ballad *Kaiyula*,l.1.3) and seems another expression of unpretentious strength. I am unable to supply associations for *Stinging-flies* (l. 28.1).

Poetic Stanzas

24-34.1: *verse passage* divided in two parts (24-28.1, 30-34.1) by a single line (29); in both linegroups, the same three elements - unusual personal names, and the phrases "departed Ilundu of Lukaile" and "Muganga woman of Ilundu" - combine to form two different formulas: personal names + "departed Ilundu of Lukaile" (**a**'s: 24-25, 25-26, 30-31.1, 34-34.1) and "my friend" + personal names + "Muganga woman of Ilundu" (**b**'s: 28-28.2, 32-33); these formulas, in turn, comprise two compound stanzas, one in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 3, (24-25, 25-26, 28-28.2) and one in **aba**, 5 + 2 + 2, (30-31.1, 32-33, 34-34.1) separated by a single line (29) that recapitulates the immediately preceding linegroup (22-23)

35-41: Passage in two sections formed according to the formula: placename (35.1, 38.1)/ "he finds" + noun + verb (36, 38.2-39)/ expansion of discovery (37-37.1, 40)..."he wandered on" (38,41); note that the marked word order, verb + subject, finalizes the passage.

Villages push against each other.
40 He lacked a place to pasture cattle.
He migrated on, Mbibi.

When he reached Ihangiro of Nkumbya,
He finds pastures unfold and multiply.
My lord, my father,
When he reached Kabaale he inquired.
He said, "By whom is this land ruled?"
They said, "It's ruled by Ruhinda."
45 *Mounds-for-him-raised, the Elder,*
Spits in a bull's horn,
And Semiroyal ones of Ihangiro wash all night.

He then took cattle.
He then took four-and-four, eight bulls.
He added two milking cows.

50 He said, "Go on my behalf, salute Ruhinda, *Mounds-for-him-raised.*
Say, 'He has emigrated,
Rukiza of Kilomba
Lion of the Muganga,
Cures-others cures not himself.'
Say, 'He seeks a place to settle.'"

They came and they brought those words.
They greeted his presence with them and they spoke them truly.

55 He asked them, "Where is he?"
They said, "My lord, he is in Kabaale."

Ebyalo byatekelana.
40 Yabula mbali ya kulis' ente.
Yafuluka Mbibi.

Kayagobile Ihangilo lya Nkumbya,
Ashanga enyeya zakanya zaba zingi.
Waitu taata,
Kayagobile omu Kabaale yabaza
Ati, 'Eihanga nilitwaalwa owa?'
Bati, 'Nilitwaalwa Ruhinda'
45 *Lya Nyamutindilwa olukulu,*
Nyamuchwa omu ihembe ly' enumi,
Enfula ikalala ninaaba zoona za Ihangilo.

Akagila ente.
Akagila enumi ina na ina munana.
Yataho ente ibili z' enzaile.

50 Ahi, 'Mugye mundamize Ruhinda lwa *Nya mutindilwa.*
Muti, 'Yafuluka,
Rukiza *lwa Kilomba,*
Entale y' Omuganga,
Aganga-banu atayegange.'
Muti, 'Naiga obutuulo.'

Baija. Babileeta.
Babimuhabukya. Babimugambilakwo.

55 Yagila ati, 'Ali nkahai?'
Bati, 'Waitu ali Kabaale.'

Plot Outline

Lines 41.1-47
Finally, in Kabaale in Ihangiro Kingdom he discovers what he is looking for. He inquires about the local ruler.

Lines 48-53:
Sending cattle as tribute to the king, Rukiza requests a place to settle

Notes

41 *Mbibi* refers to Rukiza; see note to 4.1.

41.1 *Ihangilo of Nkumbya*. In epics a placename is sometimes made more specific by appending the name of its founder.

44.2 *Ruhinda*. The Bahinda dynasty ruled a majority of precolonial Haya kingdoms. This King Ruhinda may represent its founder in the kingdom of Ihangilo.

45 *Mounds-for-him-raised* is a praisename that refers to great amounts of royal tribute.

46–47 *Spits...wash all night*. This praise is said to represent adulation evoked by the king, as do mounds of tribute. Horns are said to have been used as royal water vessels held by servants. Royal saliva would be protected to prevent its use by sorcerers. The sign of spitting conveys a status relationship here, as it does in *Mugashal* (81.1), there with an insulting meaning. *Semi-royal*status (*obu-fula*) accrues to the members of a sub-clan that gives a bride to the king. Semi-royalty could practice forms of etiquette and self-display denied other commoners.

52 *Cures-others cures not himself* is a proverb used to praise the ethic of care embodied by Rukiza. It turns on the pun *oku-ganga* “to treat (for illness)” and *Ba-ganga*, the name of Rukiza’s clan. Rukiza’s name itself may be a pun on *oku-kiza* “to cure or make well.”

Poetic Stanzas

41.1-42: Pattern of incremental repetition begun in previous passage started here (placename/ "he finds" + noun + verb) but shifts and propels action into new phase.

48-49: Stanza in **aab** formed by repetition and variation of initial verb.

50.1-53: Stanza in **ab**bb**a'** formed by lines composed according to the formula, locutive + verb (**a'**s: 50.1, 53), contrasted with lines that have no verb (51, 51.1, 52).

54-54.1: Double verb formation doubled to form a couplet.

55-57: Stanza in **aabb** formed by a couplet with verbs in the indicative composed of a question and answer exchange (**a'**s: 55, 55.1) contrasted with a couplet with verbs in the subjunctive composed of orders (**b'**s: 56-57).
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He said, "Let him dwell at Kabaale in Mubunda.
Be that place his for cutting banana leaves."

My friend, drums sounded from the Calling-place.
People gathered.
He said, "Go, and return when you have built cattle-byres
And dwellings for the *Long-lived-one*"
They came to Rukiza,
Rukiza Mbibi.
They constructed houses for the *Long-lived-one*.
Cattle-byres they built. The work was done.

When they happened to go and cast their eyes–
One happened to go and cast his eyes–
He went and he saw Rukiza's sister.

My friend, my friend,
They traveled and they went,
They reported to King Ruhinda.
They said, "But at Rukiza's
We saw a maiden–
Perhaps his daughter
Perhaps his sister–
But she was not beautiful–
Only as the sun!"

King Ruhinda, *Mounds-for-him-raised*, sent matchmakers.
Rukiza addressed them, saying, "She is my sister.
If he wants to marry her,
Let him furnish cattle.

Ati, 'Agye aikale Mubunda Kabaale.
Bube nibwo buchwo bw' embabi.'

Baaba, engoma bagita aha Lubingo.
Abantu lyahulula.
Ahi, 'Mugye musige mwamwombekela ebilaalo

Na amaju g' okulalamu *Nyakutununta*.'
Baija omwa Rukiza,
Rukiza Mbibi.
Bagombeka amaju *Nyakutununta*.
Ebilaalo babikola byaahwa.

Kabagiile kugya kunaga amaisho -
Omoi kugya kunaga amaisho -
Yagya yabona munyanya Rukiza.

Baaba, baaba
Bagenda bagya,
Babaluulila omukama Lugomola.
Bahi, 'Kyonkai Rukiza
Manya twabona omwisiki -
Manya muhala
Manya munyanya -
Kyonkai talashemeile:
Nashana eizooba!'

Omukama Ruhinda *lwa Nyamutindilwa* yatwekayo ab' okushelela.
Yagila ati, 'Inye ni munyanyazi.
Kalaaba nagonza kumushweela,
Agile ente.

Plot Outline

Lines 54-62.1
The king grants his request and Rukiza builts there. <a name="line 63">Lines 63-66.4:
Rukiza's sister, not mentioned before, is a beautiful woman and becomes known to King Ruhinda.

Lines 67-74.1:
The king sends matchmakers to arrange a marriage. Rukiza specifies the brideprice payment, and the king provides it.

Notes

57 *Cutting banana leaves*is a metonym for domestic life based on the many homely uses the leaves serve —plates, platters, cups, cooking vessels and others.

58 *Calling-place*. Ihangilo's royal drums were sounded at the *Lubungo*, literally, "dung heap," the same word used to describe the place of Rukiza's imaginary transgression, l. 84ff.

66.4 *Only as the sun!* is a hyperbole that reveals the irony in the previous line.

Poetic Stanzas

58-60: Concatenated stanza alternately in **aab** formed by contrast between lines that contain verb phrases (**a**'s: 58, 59, 59.1) and one line that does not (**b**: 60), and in **aabb** formed by contrast between a couplet composed of a call and response unit (**a**'s: 59-59) and a couplet composed of orders (**b**'s: 59.1-60).

60.1-62.1 Stanza in **aabb** composed of couplets that cohere by chaining (**a**'s: 60.1-61) and by parallelism (reversed syntax: verb + direct object/ direct object + verb, **b**'s: 62-62.1).
63-63.2: Stanza in **aab** formed by repetition; double verb confirms finalization.

69-71: Stanza in **aab**(b) formed by contrast between multiple lines beginning with *Agile*, "Let him bring" (**a**'s: 69, 70) and a single line beginning with *Ateho*, "Let him add" (**b**: 70.1); the figure is then *refinalized* with a line beginning with a verb in the indicative mood, which contrasts to the subjunctive of all the preceding verbs in the stanza.

70 Let him furnish calabashes of beer: four-and-four,
eight of them
Let him present mead: two pots."
They brought them to the *Long-lived-one*.
He said, "Return and tell him this:
Address him, say, 'Go and give four cows in milk.
Return and present two steers.
My friend, then you've made the bridal payment, then
you've completed it.'"
He made the bridal payment, he completed it.

75 But he returned to this, Rukiza;
He said, "When the moon is new,

Let him bring beer,
Four-and-four, eight calabashes."
He said, "Let him present mead,
Four-and-four, eight pots."
He said, "Let them come and stay the night at the pre
nuptial fete.
At sunrise let me come and bestow my sister
And let him marry her, all you Baganga!"

They went and they ripened it.
It fermented, and they brought it.
They stayed the night at the prenuptial fete.
The sun rose and he married her.

80 It had been one year since the bride was married.
My lord, my father, she emerged from her seclusion.
They came and accused him behind his back.
They said, "But father, King Ruhinda, *Mounds-for-him-raised*,

70 Agile amaalwa ganai na ganai munana.
Ateho enjoga z' obwooki ibili.'

Baileta *Nyakutununta*.
Ati, 'Mushube mugye mumugambile,
Mugile muti, 'Ogye ogile ente inai eizaile,
Oshube oteho engumba ibili.
Baaba, wajuga waamala."

Yajuga yaamala.

75 Kandi yashuba Rukiza
Ati, 'K' okwezi kulayema,

Aleete amaalwa,
Ganai na ganai munana.'
Ati, 'Ateho enjoga z' obwooki
Inai na inai munana.
Ahi, 'Baije balaale omu kasiki.

Bukye nyije musigile munyanyazi.
Amushweele inywe Baganga!'

Bagya bagaalika.
Gahya bagaleeta.
Balala aha kasiki.
Bwakya yashweela.

80 Akaba amazile omwaaka gumoi ashweile.
Waitu taata omugole yayalukile.
Baija bamulega.
Bati, 'Kyonka taata mukama Ruhinda *lwa Nya mutindilwa*,

Plot Outline

Lines 75-78.2:
Then Rukiza specifies the amount of beer required for the prenuptial fete.

Lines 78-78.3:
The king provides the beer.

Notes

70 *Mede* is beer made from honey. In requiring beer and cattle in bridewealth and then more beer for the pre-nuptual fete (*kasiki*) Rukiza enacts his status of clan patriarch.

78–78.2 Rukiza's zeal in enacting clan-regulated wedding ceremonials represents the concerns of a clan patriarch. It is surpassed only by the careful preparation of the qrotesque wedding party in the marriage of Wamala's daughter in *Mugasha*. Both heros represent and defend the ethics of clan.

Poetic Stanzas

72-74.1: Stanza in **aab**(b) formed by contrast between multiple lines beginning with verbs inflected in the subjunctive mood (**a**'s: 72, 72.1, 73) and a single line beginning with a verb in the indicative mood (**b**: 74); the figure is then *refinalized* with a line beginning with a verb inflected in the third person (74.1), which contrasts to the second person of all preceding verbs in the stanza; all verbs in this stanza are doubled.

76-78.2: Compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 3, formed syntactically and lexically; the initial pairs of couplets (**a**'s: 76-77, 77.1-77.2) are formed as initial subjunctive verb + direct object/ number formula; and the final couplet (**b**: 78-78.1) turns on parallelism between initial subjunctive verbs in each line "let them come, let them stay the night..." and "let it dawn, let me come"; a final line (78.2) confirms the finalization with a initial subjunctive verb and a formula that will become thematic "All you Baganga!"

80-81.1: Stanza in **aab** formed syntactically by contrast of past perfect tenses (**a**'s: 80, 81) with near past double verb formation (81.1).

Rukiza oversteps the bounds.
Rukiza oversteps the bounds.

To show how he oversteps the bounds, Rukiza–
Milk, he pours on the dungheap.
85 Butter, he plasters on the walls."

Ruhinda grew angry.
He said, "And those, the ones my father left me!
And father never poured milk on the dungheap.
Butter, he never plastered on the walls."

He said, "Go sound the drum at the Calling-place."
It spoke.
He said, "Tomorrow seize them all,
90 The long-horns and the spotted ones,
The blacks and the grays."

My mother, my mother,
One man went out from among them
He traveled in the night.
Before dawn, my lord, my father,
He found them milking.
They were at the cattle fire.

The little man was poorly dressed.

Rukiza yashaagya.
Rukiza yashaagya.

Kumanya yashaagya Rukiza:
(Amajuta) Amata nazanisa omu lubungo.
85 Amajuta nahomesa ensiika.'

Ruhinda yatamwa.
Yagila ati, 'N' ezo taata yansigiile!
Na taata talazanisize matai omu lubungo.
Amajuta talagahomesize nsiika.'

Ahi, 'Mugye bagite aha Lubungo.'
Yalaha.
Ahi, 'Nyenkya mwinyage zoona,
90 N' engaaju n' empogo,
Baaba, n' ez' esiina n' empula.'

Maawe, maawe,
Alugwaho omushaija omoi
Akagenda omu kilo.
Kabwabaile, waitu taata.
Akashanga mbainikila.
Bali omu makoomi g' ente.

Akashaija kakaba kajweete kubi.

Plot Outline

Lines 80-91: A Call
About a year later, some men falsely accuse Rukiza to the king of flaunting the social value of cattle. The king is outraged and orders Rukiza's cattle to be confiscated.

Lines 92-98.1: Another Call
One man leaves the court and travels to Rukiza's settlement. There he meets herdsmen milking cattle and claims to them that, despite his poor appearance, he has established a blood brotherhood with Rukiza.

Notes

82–87 The actions that Rukiza is wrongfully accused of offend royal ethics of cattle holding. His profligate acts deny symbolic, exchange, and use values of cattle and their products, which support patronage and, in some degree, the state itself. Note the ethical and linguistic parallelism: the (false) report of Rukiza's exceeding the bounds evokes the king's defense of the royal ethics of cattle ownership; while Rukiza's observation of cattle exceeding the bounds (12.2) evokes the patriarch's kin-like ethical concern for their welfare. Both are calls to action; they motivate and frame the events that follow.
88 *Calling-place* is the same word as dungheap (*lubungo*); I am not sure how these closely juxtaposed uses are associated; perhaps they are as royal assets (manure and drum) that proclaim themselves from afar (by smell and sound).

90–91 *Long-horns*,*spotted ones*... are part of an extensive set of terms for describing cattle.

93.2 *Cattle fire*i s a campfire whose smoke is used to fumigate the animals, reducing the number of their insect pests.
This episode is the second part of epic's principal Call. Rukiza grants the man's request to see him, although the his claim is never verified. His assertion of blood brotherhood, a voluntary, socially created form of kinship, is sufficient to touch the patriarch's ethical sense. In some versions of Rukiza, the man's presence is announced by laughter of children, for whom nakedness elicits amusement. As an instrument of the ethical appeal, children embody kin-based, clan ethics, as the drum that summons a warrior to a king's service embodies the royal state in *Kachwenyanja*.

Poetic Stanzas

81.2-87: Three stanzas in **abb** (81.2-82.1, 83-85, 86.1-87) formed lexically and syntactically; note the important interpolated line (86) and the fact that the final stanza (86.1-87) is formed both as **abb** (by syntactic parallelism) and as **aab** (by lexical repetition of "father"); the final two lines cohere by virtue of a syntactic device used also in lines 62-62.1, in which paired sentences reverse the word order of verb and direct object, VB+DO becomes DO+VB.

88-91: Stanza in **aabb** formed by a couplet that coheres by the formula, initial locutive + subjunctive verb, contrasted with a couplet that coheres by the formula, 0verb + cattle descriptors; note interpolated one word line (88.1).
94-95.1: Stanza in **aab** formed by two lines that cohere as subject + verb (94,95) contrasted with a line formulated as direct object + verb (95.1).

Plot Outline

Lines 92-98.1: (cont)
One man leaves the court and travels to Rukiza's settlement. There he meets herdsmen milking cattle and claims to them that, despite his poor appearance, he has established a blood brotherhood with Rukiza.

Lines 99-103:
Notified by his herdsmen, Rukiza has the man properly clothed and grants him an audience.
Lines 104-106.1:
The man recounts the accusation to Rukiza and warns him about the impending attack.

Notes

99 Rukiza's clansmen cannot resolve the contradiction between the man's apparant low status, which argues against letting him see Rukiza, and his claimed blood -brotherhood, which argues for it. The patriarch upholds the precepts of kin without question. Note that Rukiza leaves the embrace of his praisworthy wife to answer the call, as does the royal warrior in *Kachwenyanja*(ll. 108-118), testimonies to the strength of their ethical committment.

Poetic Stanzas

96-98.1: Compound stanza, 2 + 2 + 2, concatenated in **aab** and **aba**; as **aab** pairs that cohere by lexical repetition (96-96.1: "going"; 97-97.1: "Lukiza") are contrasted with a pair that does not cohere in this way (97-97.1: the latter is the only pair whose first line is chained with the second line of the preceding pair (via /nywa/ "drink," the root of "blood brother") and the only pair that has a line with no verb; as **aba**, pairs in which the *answer* is introduced by a locutive (96-96.1, 98-98.1) are contrasted with a pair in which the *question* is so introduced (97-97.1).

99-99.2: Stanza concatenated in **aab** and in **abb**; as **aab**, lines that begin with single verbs (99, 99.1) contrast with a line that begins with double initial verbs (99.2); as **abb**, an initial line with verbs inflected in a 3rd person plural subject (99) contrasts with two following lines in a 3rd person singular subject (99.2, 99.2).

100-100.2 Stanza in **aab** formed by contrast between two narrative lines that cohere by virtue of past perfect principal verbs (100, 100.1) and a single line of praise (100.2)

101-101.3 Stanza concatenated in **aab** and **aba**; following an expletive of address (101) an **aba** pattern is formed by alternating lines with 3rd person plural verbal inflections (101.1, 101.3) with a single line with a 3rd person singular verbal inflection (101.2); **abb** is formed by a line that begins with a single verb (101.1) contrasted with two lines that begin with double verb formations (101.2, 101.3); note the similarity with the concatenation and finalization in 99-99.2).

102-103: Stanza in **aba** formed by contrast between lines with similarly inflected verbs, one of them repeated (102, 103) and a single intervening line marked by a 3rd person narrative verb in the adverbial past perfect (102.1).

95 My lord, his leather cloak was badly tattered.
His penis, he covered with his fingers.
"You man, where are you going?"
He said, "I'm going to see Rukiza."
They said, "Rukiza has some tie with you?"
"Rukiza is my blood brother."
"A blood brotherhood! Where did you pledge it?"
He said, "At Lukokwa and Lulambili."

They tried to think of what to do with him but couldn't.

One among them left.
He went and told Rukiza.

100 Rukiza had not yet risen.
He slept with his wife Luhunge, *Forbids-the-hafted-knife*
Arm that embraces undaunted warriors.

My lord, my father,
They told him.
He arose and he stood outside under the eaves.
They brought water to wash and they left.

He said, "Quickly, go and bring him to me."
When he saw him at the gateposts,
He said, "Bring a leather kilt and cloak and dress him."

"You sir, how came you?"
He said, "How to tell you, Father Rukiza?"
He said, "I left them saying you overstepped the bounds,"

95 Waitu enkanda etagataagukile.
Embolo kagitaileho ebyala.
'Iwe mushaija nogya nkahai?'
Ahi, 'Ningya kuleeba Rukiza.'
Bati, 'Rukiza mukwaatana 'hai?'
'Rukiza ni munywaanyi wange.'
'Mukanywaanila nkaha?'
Ahi, 'Lukokwa na Lulambili.'

Baleeba okwo balamugila kwabula.

Yalugwaho omo.
Yagya yagambila Rukiza.

100 Rukiza akaba atakaimukile.
Anyiamile n' omukaziwe Luhunge *lwa Kazila-muholo.*
Mukono gufumbata emanzi ezabaile zitangila.

Waitu taata,
Bamugambila.
Yaimuka yagya aha kishashi.
Bamunabula bamala.

Ahi, 'Iloko mugye mumuleete.'
Kayamuboine omu biti by' eilembo,
Ahi, 'Muleete engutu n' ebeebo mumujweeke.'

'Iwe mushaija, waleetwaki?'
Ahi, 'Nkugambileki Ta Rukiza?'
Ahi, 'Nasiga ngu oshaagize.'

He said, "saying butterfat, you plaster on walls.

105 Milk, you pour on the dungheap.
He said, "Ruhinda *Mounds-for-him-raised*
He said, "has ordered all the drums to sound."

Rukiza Mbibi
Took Water-of-yam-leaves,
He said, "Go and set the *shoju* grass aflame."
He said, "If he is a Muganga
Let him grow today."
110 He set the flames, my lord.
Wherever fire passed, my lord,
The shoju grass was growing.

My friend, he took Honey Bee, *The Whizzer*,
He said, "If you are a Muganga,"
He said, "If they strike you, bite them."
He said, "If they flee you, buzz them, all you Baganga."

He took Water-of-yam-leaves and Does-not-penetrate and Impotence,
115 He said, "Surround them on each flank."
He said, "Be it there you intercept the cattle of the *Long-lived-one*."

Cattle went to pasture and they returned.
Himba appeared on the opposite river bank.
They watched the cattle descend.

The invaders came to seize Rukiza's cattle.

Ahi, 'Ngu amajuta nohomesa ensiika.

105 Amata nozaanisa omu lubungo.
Ahi, 'Ruhinda *lwa Nyamutindilwa*
Ahi, 'Yagamba kwilaya zoona.'

Rukiza Mbibi
Yagila Maizi g'olubota
Ahi, 'Ogende oyokye Ekishoju.'
Ahi, 'Kalaba ali Muganga
Amele mbwenu.'
110 Yayokya waitu.
Mbali ali omulilo guli kuluga waitu
Ebishoju nibelmela.

Baaba yagila Njoki *Nyakajenjela*,
Ahi, 'Kolaaba oli Muganga,'
Ahi, 'Kabalakutela obalye.'
Ahi, Kabalakuleka olabajunjula, inywe Baganga.'

Yagila Maizi g'olubota na Kitachuga na Mbolo efile,

115 Ahi, 'Mulabe omu lubaju n' omu lubaju.'
Ahi, 'Mube nimwo mutangila ente *Nyakutununta*.'

Zatula zataaha.
Bahimba bayema buseli.
Babona zasooka.

Batahamu kwinyaga eza Rukiza.

Plot Outline

Lines 104-106.1:
The man recounts the accusation to Rukiza and warns him about the impending attack.

Lines 107-116:
Rukiza summons his clansmen-warriors and deploys them for battle.

Notes

108.1 *Set the shoju grass aflame*. After being burnt in seasonal fires that control vegetation on intervillage lands, *shoju* grass begins to grow again and pricks the foot (see I. 202).

117.1 *Himba* are clans whose occupational specialty is cattle-herding. They are allied with ruling Hinda clans in several interlacustrine kingdoms.

Poetic Stanzas

104-106.1 Compound stanza, 2 + 3 + 2, in **aab** formed by an initial pair (104-104.1) that coheres by *reversed parallelism* according to the formula, address + verb with interrogative particle -ki / verb with -ki + address, followed by three lines that also cohere by forms of parallelism (syntactic, evident in the repetition of the quoted locutive *ngu*, 104.2-104.3 and in the formulaic, repeated word order, direct object + verb phrase, 104.3 - 105); these linegroups that cohere by parallelism are contrasted with and finalized by a pair (106-106.1) that contains one line with no verb and coheres by virtue of enjambment.

107-116: Verse passage in **aab** formed by three linegroups (107-110.2, 111-113.2, 114-116) that cohere with one another by virtue of three mirrored component parts; first, Lukiza addresses a named kinsman (107-108, 111, 114; note that enjambment of the first instance mirrors that in previous line pair, 106-106.1); second, Lukiza gives two part orders, introduced by a locutive and framed in the subjunctive or the near future (108.1-109.1, 113-113.1, 115-116); the first two linegroups (**a**'s) contrast with the third (**b**') by the inclusion of an additional line, "He said, 'If [he is/ you are] a Muganga,'"(109, 112); note also that the first linegroup (107-110.2) coheres internally by mirror structure: "set aflame" (108.1, 110), adverbial clause (109, 110.1), "grow" (109.1, 110.2).

Plot Outline

Lines 117-124:
When the king's warriors arrive to confiscate Rukiza's cattle, the clansmen beat them back, killing many in the process.

Lines 125-127:
Rukiza spares the life of the single remaining royal warrior but mutilates him and sends him to the king with a defiant message.

Lines 128-133:
The king again summons warriors and attacks Rukiza, with similar results.

Notes

118.1 *Shoju grass* covers their legs, lacerates them and impedes their march.

125.1 Rukiza's mutilation of the remaining royal warrior is a statement couched in a violent discourse of the body. Sparing the enemy's life, he inscribes him with a defiant message to the king. A similar message framed in the somatic discourse of clans, but seen from the opposite side of the institutional battleground, appears reprehensible and ethically foreign in *Kachwenyanja*: ll. 184-184.1, 216-217).

129.1–131 The king and the clan patriarch summon more troops.

Poetic Stanzas

121-124: Stanza cohering by virtue of the repeated word "killed", and formed in **aab** by contrast between lines in a number sequence (121-123) and a single line that substitutes a named person for numbered arrows(124).

125-134.1 Verse passage in **abab**; four linegroups (125-127, 129-131, 132-133.1, 134-134.1 - 125.2 is apparently a mistake) that contrast compound stanzas (**a**'s: 125-127, 132-133.1, formed internally as **aab**, 2 + 2 + 1, two lines with verbs inflected in 3rd person singular indicative (125-125.1, 132-132.1) + two lines with verbs inflected in 2nd person singular subjunctive (126-126.1, 132.2-133) + a single line of mixed person and number (127, 133.1); alternating with these compound stanzas are couplets (**b**'s in the overall pattern of **abab**, 129-129.1 + 130-131(doubled), 134-134.1) that are formed according to the syntactic formula, double verb + praisename/ single verb.

Shoju grass covered their legs.
My friend, Honey Bees buzzed and killed them.

120 He himself stood on a hilltop, Mbibi.

When he put one arrow to the string,
It killed four hundred and ninety-eight.
The second killed three hundred and seventy-two.
The fourth killed one hundred and five.
And Water-of-yam-leaves' men were also killing.

125 There remained one man.
From that man he took an eye.
He said, "Go and tell Ruhinda.
Go and tell Ruhinda, *Mounds-for-him-raised*
Say, 'Send a few, and he'll kill them.
When you send many, then we'll fight!' All you Baganga!"

Sh-sh-sh-sh-sh

He went and he told Ruhinda, *Mounds-for-him-raised*.
Ruhinda sounded the drum at the Calling-place.
130 And again they made drums speak, the men of the *Long-lived-one*.
My lord, they truly made the spears and arrows fly.

There remained one.
He cut off his hand.
He said, "Go tell Ruhinda, *Mounds-for-him-raised*,
Say, 'Send a few, he'll kill them.
When you send many, then we'll fight!' All you Baganga!"

Eshoju yabamba ebilenge.
Baaba, enjoki zabajunjula, zabaita.

120 Wenene yayema aha kabanga Mbibi.

Kayatahilemu omuhambi gumoi
Gwaita amaganai ganai mwa kyenda na munana.
Ogwa kabili gwaita amaganai gatanu mwo nshanju na babili.
Ogwa kanai gwaita kikumi mwa tanu.
Na balinya abalimu Maizi g' olubota mbaita.

125 Yasigalaho omushaija omoi.
Omushaija yamwihyamu eliisho.
Ati, 'Mugye mugambile Ruhinda.
Ogye ogambile Ruhinda *lwa Nyamutindilwa*
Oti, 'Otweke bake abaite.
Kolatweka bangi lilalwaana!' Inywe Baganga!'

Sh-sh-sh-sh-sh

Yagya yamugambila Ruhinda *lwa Nyamutindilwa*.
Ruhinda yagita aha Lubungo.
130 Bashuba bazilaya *Banyakutununta*.

Waitu, lyalashanakwo.

Akasigalaho omoi.
Yamutema omukono.
Ati, 'Ogende ogye ogambile Ruhinda *lwa Nya mutindilwa*,
Oti, 'Otweke bake abaite
Kolatweka bangi lilalwaana!' Inywe Baganga!'

Plot Outline

Lines 134-138:
King Ruhinda accepts the advice of his counselors to stop the attacks.

Lines 138.1-140:
Another year passes, and Rukiza's sister begins to bear children, who reach three in number, including the designated royal heir.

Lines 141-147.2:
After several more years, the king asks Rukiza's sister for the secret of her brother's strength; at first she demurs, but after warning him of swift revenge should Rukiza be harmed, she relents.

Notes

135–135.1 The king's advisers at the court, the *balamata*, were drawn from commoner clans. In clan-accented discourse here, as in Haya folktales, they appear as voices of moderation. Separating the control of land from the control of people articulates a division between clan and state. The state is founded on the control of capital in land and cattle. Clans regulate behavior that maintains properly balanced relationships between groups of people, between living and dead, and between society and the natural environment. The advisers remind the king of the focus of his institutional practice.

Poetic Stanzas

135-137.1 Compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 2; each of the three couplets (135-135.1, 136-136.1, 137-137.1) has *ensi*, "land," in the first line in final position; the first couplet coheres internally by virtue of repetition of the question, "do you want to rule...?"; the second couplet coheres by virtue of repetition of initial locutives; the third couplet coheres by 3rd singular inflection of verbs (a marked 4 of them in 2 lines); contrasts in the verbal inflections of the quoted speech create the **aab** pattern: 1st and 2nd persons in the first two couplets(**a**'s), 3rd person in the final couplet(**b**).

138-138.2 Stanza in **abb** formed by contrast between one line formed as verb + subject (138) and two lines formed as subject + verb (138.1-138.2).

139-140: Stanza in **aab**(a') formed by number sequence (139-139.1) finalized (139.2) by omission of an initial verb, "She bore"; the figure is *refinalized* by restoring the initial verb but substituting social rank for numerical order (140).

142-147.2 Compound stanza in **ab**b**a**', 3 + 2 + 2 + 3, formed by contrast between husband's conversational utterances (**a**'s: 142-143, 147-147.2) and those of wife (**b**'s: 144-145, 146-146.1); husband's utterances cohere by repetition of the address, "my wife,": in final position of their first lines (142, 147) and of the interrogative particle (-ki) suffixed to the verb (143, 147.2); wife's utterances cohere internally as **ab**b**a**'~ by contrast between lines with a verb in final position (**a**'s: 144, 146.1) and lines with "...kill(s) Lukiza" in final position (**b**'s: 145, 146).

They went and told *Mounds-for-him-raised*.
One man stepped forward, an elder.

135 He said, "Oh king, do you wish to rule the land,
Or do you wish to rule its people?"
He said, "I wish to rule the land."
He said, "Then let Rukiza of Kilomba be,
Lest he finish off the land
And finally come and kill you as well."

He let him be, Ruhinda did, *Mounds-for-him-raised*.
A year passed.
The woman became pregnant.

She bore a child.
She bore a second child.
A third child
140 She bore – the royal heir.

That one child,
When he was weaned,
Ruhinda said, "Now tell me truthfully, my wife:
That Rukiza,
My men – how was he killing them?"
The woman said, "Now, I would tell you,"
145 "But I refuse to tell, lest you kill Rukiza."
She said, "And on him who kills Rukiza,
Before twilight of that day will I take revenge."

He answered, "But we two have children, my wife.

Bagya bamugambila *Nyakutununta*.
Yalugwaho omushaija omoi mukulu.

135 Yagil' ati, "Mbele mukama, ogonza kutwaala ensi,
Anga ogonza kutwaala abantu?"
Ahi, "Ngonza kutwaala ensi."
Ati, "Mbwenu olekele Rukiza *lwa Kilomba*
Atakumala ensi
Akalemwa akaija akaita na iwe."

Yalekela Ruhinda *lwa Nyamutindilwa*.
Omwaaka gwahwa.
Mukazi yatwaala enda.

Yazaala omwaana.
Yazaala omwaana wa kabili.
Omwaana wa kashatu
140 Yamuzaala n' engoma.

Omwaana omoi ogu
Kayabaile yachuuka,
Ahi, 'Naho ngambilage, mukazi wange,
Wenene Rukiza,
Abantu bange akaba nabaisaaki?'
Omukazi ahi, 'Naho nkugambile,'
145 'Ninyanga kukugambila otakwiita Rukiza.'
Ati, 'Kyonka aliita Rukiza
Bwaigolo inye nakumwehoola.'

Ndi ogu, 'Manya twazaile hamoi mukazi wange

Rukiza–why would I kill him?
Now that so many years have passed."

She said, "That Rukiza, Rukiza Mbibi,
My friend, Rukiza's heart is in the roof peak of the house.

150 The other is in the fire of the Spotted bull.
The beating flesh alone dwells in Rukiza's breast."
She said, "If they would let an arrow fly,
And it fall into the roof peak of the house,
And another fall into the fire of the Spotted bull
Then Rukiza you have killed."

Women, women are betrayers.

155 When dawn's first rays appeared,
They opened chickens, and they found it's in the roof peak of the house.
The other is in the fire of the Spotted bull.

My lord, my father, they augured hard.
They studied entrails and they found it's in the roof peak of the house.
The other is in the fire of the Spotted bull.
My lord, my father, he did not sound the drum.
They sent the message by word of mouth, O *Long-lived-one*.

160 He said, "You two,
Go, arrive there in the early morning before they've unlocked the doors.
Let fly and let it fall into the fire of the Spotted bull,

Mbwenu Rukiza nkyaita k'akolaki?
Emiaka nka yahwa mingi.'

Ahi, 'Wenene Rukiza, Rukiza Mbibi,
Baaba, omwoyo gwa Rukiza guli omu kashwi k' enju.

150 Ogusigaile guli omu koomi ya Lugondo.
Entununsi yonka niyo etuula Rukiza omu ibeele.'
Ahi, 'Kabakulasha omuhaambi
Gukagwa omu kashwi k' enju,
Ogusigaile gukagwa omu koomi ya Lugondo,
Aho manti Rukiza wamwiita.'

Abakazi, abakazi baaba mbanzi.

155 Kabwasingile bukakya
Bashala bashanga guli omu kashwi k' enju.

Ogusigaile guli omu koomi ya Lugondo .

Waitu taata, balaguza muno
Bachunza bashanga guli omu kashwi k' enju.

Ogusigaile guli omu koomi ya Lugondo.
Waitu taata, tiyalahize ngoma.
Balaalizangana *Nyakutununta*.

160 Akagila ati, 'Inywe ababili,
Mugye mugobe bwankya muno muno, batakahilemu na mpigi.
Mugulashe gugwe omu koomi ya Lugondo,

Plot Outline

Lines 148-53.1:
She tells of his magical multiple hearts, which are located outside Rukiza's body.

Lines 155-59.1:
After confirming this intelligence through divination, the king summons his warriors.

Lines 160-63.1:
The king orders archers to pierce the magical hearts, and they do so .

Notes

Exogamy and patriliny sometimes cast women as dangerous mediators of clan boundaries, producing children for potential rivals and conveying “inside” information that could later bring harm to the clans of their fathers. This inter-clan concern appears here in a context defined by clan and state

149–150 Rukiza’s magical hearts are located in places that proclaim the association of home, cattle, and body within the unity of clan. The roof peak of an old-style Haya house (*msonge*) is formed by the top of the central pillar of the round dwelling, the apex of its conical or onion-shaped roof. At the base of the pillar is the hearth and central living space, the most interior space in family life (Seitel 1980:1). Rukiza’s heart lies at the core of family. His other magical heart lies in the cattle kraal in the fire that warms the herdsmen before sunrise (l. 93.2) and keeps the cattle healthy and free of insect pests.

154 *Betrayers*. This proverbial statement articulates a male view of a result of the contradiction between exogamy and patriarchy. It is used as an aside here.

155–158 Augury was one of the duties performed by particular clans at court. Here chicken entrails are consulted.

159 The king does not use the drum to summon his subjects to war lest Rukiza be warned by its roar.

Poetic Stanzas

148-164: Verse passage composed of 4 pairs of stanzas (148-151 and 152-153.1, 155-156 and 157-158, 160-161.1 and 162-163.1) finalized by single lines or pairs of lines (154, 159-159.1, 164); all stanzas repeat the lexical formula "...in the roofpeak of the house/ ...in the fire of the spotted bull" but each pair of stanzas differs in its deployment; in the first pair the lines are the middle of a quatrain; in the second pair they are the final lines of a triplet; in the third pair they are the final lines of a quatrain; each pair coheres semantically as well.

Plot Outline

Lines 164-174:
The archers call Rukiza out to battle, and in his weakened state he is soon slain and his cattle driven off.

Notes

165 In another version of this epic, one sung by the bard Kishwa, the clan patriarch recognizes the imminence of his death and orders his followers: “Spread my leather cloak for me in the forecourt,/ Lest they pierce me and I spill out upon the ground./ Bring fresh milk for me,/ Lest they pierce me and I spill out blood.” He enriches the social and symbolic embodiment of non-royal cattle ownership.

171.2 The word for *life serpent*is *enkorantima*, which also refers to a black, poisonous snake. An individual’s spiritual essence or soul is envisioned as a snake (*enjoka*), which is an agency of thought (*Kitekele*: l. 209) and desire (*Kitekele*: l. 210.1, *Kaiyula*: 284) and feeling (*Kaiyula*: l. 379). Snakes are associated with spirits and may be used as vehicles for praise of another (*Mbali Oluga*: l. 38) or of oneself (*Kaitaba*: l. 496). A snake is born in each individual person, dwells within, motivates feeling and action, and dies with him or her or separates from the mortal body as an immortal spirit, according to some. It is often called *lugondo* “spotted one” (*Kaiyula*: ll. 284, 383), which is the same word for “spotted bull.” These meanings converge in *Rukiza* (ll. 150, 153, 156, 158, 161, 163) when the “Fire of the Spotted Bull” becomes the dwelling place for the hero’s heart.

The other let fall into the roof peak of the house."

My friend, they came early.
Behind them were many others.
They let fly and it fell into the roof peak of the house.
The other fell into the fire of the Spotted bull.

My friend, they stood at the fence. They called him.

165 When he did arise, Mbibi,
My lord, and come into the hearth room,
He collapsed and fell.

There, under the eaves, my father, with his bow,
Putting arrow to string,
Letting fly–
It did not reach the gateposts of the forecourt.

One standing there, my friend, at the gateposts of the forecourt
170 Shot an arrow–
My father, and it fell.

My friend, it fell into his chest,
It fell and severed his life serpent,
My friend, and his heart it split.

Rukiza Mbibi collapsed and he fell.
His cattle they seized and they brought them.
They found those of king already pastured, settled down.

Ogundi gugwe omu kashwi k' enju.'

Baaba, baija kalai.
Abandi bakaba bali enyuma bangi.
Bagulasha, gagwa omu kashwi k' enju
Ogusigaile gwagwa omu koomi ya Lugondo.

Baaba, bayema aha lugo bamweeta.

165 Kayagiile kwimuka Mbibi,
Waitu, kwija omu mwanya
Yahilingita yagwa.

Aha kishasi, taata, n' obuta bwawenene,
Kayatahilemu omuhambi,
Kayalasile
Tigwachwile biti bya malembo.

Abayemile aha, baaba, ekiti kye ilembo
170 Ogwo yajugunyile,
Taata, gwagwa.

Baaba, gwagwa omu kishenge.
Gwagya gwagutula enkolantima zoona
Baaba, n' omutima yagwasa.

Rukiza Mbibi yahilingita yagwa
N' ente bainyaga baileeta.
Bakashanga ez' omukama zatuzile zatulanila.

Poetic Stanzas

165-166.1 Stanza cohering by enjambment formed in **aab** by contrast between dependent adverbial clauses (**a**'s: 165,166) and a main clause formulated as a double verb (**b**: 166.1).

167-172: Verse in **aab** composed of three stanzas that cohere semantically as: Lukiza lets fly his arrow (167-168.1); enemy lets fly his arrow (169-170.1); result - Lukiza dies (171-172); the first two stanzas mirror each other: their initial lines include an expletive of address in medial position preceded by a locative (*aha*) and no main verb; the following unit consists of verbs in the past perfect that have adverbial force (167.1-168 and 170); the verb in the final line in each stanza is inflected with a subject infix /gu/ (gw) that refers to arrow; the final stanza coheres internally as **aab** formed by contrast between lines that begin with the same verb "It fell..." and a single line whose verb is in final position, a finalizing transformation of word order emphasized by the direct object's preceding of that final verb;: the three lines of the final stanza marked, respectively, by chained repetition ("it fell" from 170.1 to 171), double verb formation and reversed word order give the feeling of successive *refinalization* of the two mirror stanzas; all three stanzas are knit together by repetition from last line of preceding to first line of succeeding stanza.

173-174: Stanza in which all three lines are marked by double verb in final position, formed as **aab** by virtue of contrast between two lines that begin with a noun (**a**'s: 173, 173.1) and a single line that begins with (an additional) verb (**b**:174).

Plot Outline

Lines 175-181:
Seeing Rukiza's cattle mixed with the royal herd, Rukiza's sister understands that her brother has been killed.

Lines 181.1-186.2:
Using a ruse, she lures the king into a vulnerable position and cuts his throat.

Notes

175.3 *She saw the grays*. Seeing Rukiza's cattle mixed in among the king's, the woman infers the events that brought them there. The cattle, like the woman herself, have become vehicles for information, public and private. Cattle and women move through society in symbolically rich exchanges of productive value. The virtues they embody can construct, alter, and ultimately destroy ties between social groups. The orbit of this woman's life, like Rukiza's, is defined by cattle.

181.1ff Rukiza's sister lures the king into a vulnerable position. She entices him with the magical means to rule more land. Her identity as a clanswoman has been reestablished by her brother's murder and her decision to pursue revenge through blood feud. Note that she influences the king through his desire for land, similar to the way the clan advisers (*balamata*) influence him to stop sending men to their death (l. 135ff). In a contrasting set of events, the widow of a state warrior lures clansmen to their doom through their desire not for land but for sexual pleasure (*Kachwenyanja*: l. 304ff). Seen through the eyes of clans, kings are land-hungry. Seen through the eyes of the state-builders, clansmen are ruled by base appetites for pleasure and reproduction (this is an underlying theme in the ballad *Mbali Oluga*). These ethical judgements seem to be based on conflicting institutional practices governing land tenure and marriage.

Poetic Stanzas

175-175.3 Stanza in **aaab** formed by lines that consist of adverbial clauses (**a**'s: 175-175.2) contrasted with a line composed of the main clause (**b**: 175.3), which is also contrastingly framed as a double verb.

176-177: Stanza in **aabb** formed by lines with negative, initial verbs used narratively (**a**'s: 176, 176.1) contrasted with quoted speech (**b**'s: 176.2, 177).

179-181: Stanza in **aaab** formed syntactically: disordered sentence components (**a**'s: 179-180) contrast with the orderly, verb + direct object (**b**: 181).

181.1-183 Compound stanza in **aab**, 2 + 2 + 1, formed by couplets (**a**'s: 181.1-182, 182.1-182.2) that cohere internally by virtue of double verb syntax and repeated initial verb, respectively, contrasted with a single, finalizing line (**b**: 183) marked by unusual syntax, direct object + verb + direct object.

184-186.2 Compound stanza in **aba**, 3 + 2 + 2, formed by contrast between linegroups comprised of narration (**a**'s: 184-185, 186.1-186.2) and a single linegroup comprised of quoted speech (**b**: 185.2-186); lines in the first linegroup cohere by virtue of initial verbs with similar inflections and create a pattern in **aab** by contrast between the implied subject of the first two verbs (he agreed, he went), which is the king, and that of the final one (she cut him) which is his wife (verbal inflection does not indicate gender in Luhaya, increasing the contrast between syntactic sameness and semantic difference).

175 The king's wife, my father, as she stood there,
And happened to cast her eyes,
Passing beyond the fence,
She went and she saw the grays.

She did not cry a lot.
She did not speak. She was still.
She thought, "Truly, I spoke
And the king killed my father's child."

She made the bed and she lay down.
The moon had reached its fullest phase.

She thought, "Now . . ."
She thought, "my husband . . . Rukiza . . .
Ruhinda, *Mounds-for-him-raised*–"
180 She thought, "let me tell you–"
She thought, "he killed my father's child."

"Now I could magically incise you.
Come, and rule Kihanja,
Rule Zinzaland,
Rule Karagwe.
And Bugabo will you rule, and Kiziba."

He agreed Ruhinda, *Mounds-for-him-raised*
185 He walked out to the bath enclosure, *Long-lived-one*.
She cut him all over, on every segment.
She said, "Lie back,
I would also cut you on the throat."
When he'd lain back

175 Omukazi kayabaile, taata, aliho
Kugya kunaga amaisho
Naluga omu lukilane
Yagya yabona eza mpuulo.

Talachuzile muno.
Talagambile, yayesiza.
Ahi, 'Lwoona ngambile.
Omkama yaita omwaana wa taata.'

Yayala yanyiama.
Omwezi gukaba guli mukelelanwa.

Ahi, 'Mbwenu...'
Ahi, 'mushaija wange...Rukiza...
Ruhinda *lwa Nyamutindilwa* -
180 Ati, 'nkugambile -'
Ahi, 'yaita omwaana wa taata.'

'Mbwenu ngye nkushandagile.
Oije otwaale Kihanja,
Otwaale Buzinja,
Otwaale Kalagwe
Na Bugabo olagitwaala na Kiziba.'

Yaikiliza Ruhinda *lwa Nyamutindilwa*
185 Yagenda omu luhuuba *Nyakutununta*.
Yamushala weena, buli kagingo.
Ati, 'Galama,
Nkushale na aha mumilo.'
Mbali yagalamiile

His voice box she took from him whole.

She slipped through the fence.
She came to Rukiza's dwelling.
She said, "How shall I tell them?"

She found him, Rukiza, not yet buried.
They buried him the entire night.

She said, "Wander, O Baganga."
She said, "King Ruhinda murdered
My father's child.
And I in revenge I left him murdered."
My friend, the Baganga wandered.

On the river, and today . . .
There's no place where the *shoju* grass won't grow,
And still it wanders,
All you Baganga.
There's no place where the elephant-grass won't dwell
And still it wanders.
Honey-bees,
And still they wander,
Baganga.

Their wandering so,
And the king's killing Rukiza–
Happened because of women.
Happened because of his sister.

For women are betrayers.
It was one who killed Rukiza Mbibi.
It was one he used to kill *the Splitter of mukoni wood; it dries.*

Shoju grass pricks the foot when short.
When it grows, it thatches a house.
All you Baganga!

Amalaka yagaiyaho goona

Yalaba omu lukilane.
Yaija omwa Rukiza.
Ahi, 'Mbagambileki?'

Akashanga wenene Rukiza batakamuziikile.
Bakamuziika omu kilo kyoona.

Ahi, 'Bunga, Baganga'
Ahi, 'Omukama Ruhinda aisile
Omwaana wa taata.
Naanye nasiga namwiita.'
Baaba, Baganga babunga.

Aha mugela na mambwenu...
Taliho mbali eshoju etamela
Na yonene ekyabunga,
Inywe Baganga.
Taliho mbali olubungo lutatuula
Na lwonene lukyabunga.
Enjoki,
Na zonene zikyabunga,
Baganga.

Zonene kubunga batyo
N' omukama Rukiza kumwita
Akazil' abakazi.
Akazil' omukazi munyanya.

Abakazi baba mbanzi.
Niwe aisile Rukiza Mbibi.
Niwe amwisize *Lugangabula-mikoni ekoma*.

Eshoju nekoza eli nto.
Kelikula neshakala enju.
Inywe Baganga

Plot Outline

Lines 187-202.2:
She returns to Rukiza's house and buries him. From that time, Rukiza's clan, is deprived of land, and forever wanders.

Notes

186.2 *Voicebox*. Slashing or cutting out the larynx (*amalaka*, plural of *eilaka*—voice) seems to be a formulaic way of slitting the throat. See *Kachwenyanja*: ll. 312.1, 331.1, 351.1, 353.

188 This rhetorical quandry about bringing bad news echoes the words of the near-naked messinger to Rukiza (l. 104.1).

189–191.1 Rukiza's sister made good her promise to exact revenge before sunset on the day of his death (ll. 146–146.1). The Baganga engage in ritual lamentation all night.

194–196.2 *Shoju grass, elephant grass, honey bees*are symbols of house, family, ubiquitousness, and strength of the downtrodden.

Poetic Stanzas

187-188: Stanza in **aab** formed by as contrast between narrative (**a**'s: 187, 187.1) and quoted speech (**b**: 188).

189.2-192 Annular structure formed lexically: outer ring comprised of "wander" and "Baganga" (189.2 and 192), inner ring composed of "kill" (190 and 191.1), and center composed of the thematically marked "child of my father."

194-196.2 Verse passage in **aab** composed of three linegroups (194-194.2, 195-195.1, 196-196.2) that mirror one another lexically; the first linegroup sets the pattern: natural category-kinsman/ "wander"/ "Baganga"; the second linegroup (195-195.1) is shortened by one line; the third (196-196.1) is shorter in the enunciation of each line; the shortening, particularly in the first line, creates an overall pattern of **aab** for the passage.

197-198.1 Stanza in **aabb** formed by contrast between a couplet (**a**'s: 197-197.1) that coheres by virtue of repeated infinitives used adverbially and a second couplet (**b**'s: 198, 198.1) that coheres by lexical repetition.

199-201: Stanza in **abb** formed by repetition._